



Delhi Public School Megacity, Kolkata

Class: 4 Session: 2026-27

Subject: English Language

Comprehension Topic: The Coral Tree

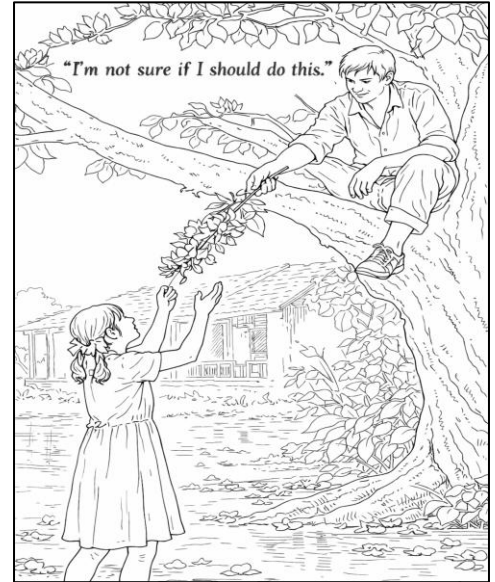
Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

The night had been hot, the rain frequent, and I slept on the veranda. In a few hours, a tonga would take me to the railway station, then to Bombay, and from there a ship to England. There would be a job, a different life. I would miss this place. When I woke up, I saw a grey morning and the smell of wet soil. A girl stood near the veranda, looking at me. I sat up. She was young, with big black eyes and pigtails tied with a bright red ribbon. "Hello," I said, smiling. She nodded. "Do you stay nearby?" She nodded again. "With your parents?" I asked. She replied, "Yes. But I can stay on my own."

"You're like me," I said, forgetting for a moment that I was an old man of twenty. I asked her, "What did you come for?"

"I want some flowers, but I can't reach them." She pointed towards the garden. "That tree, see?"

The coral tree stood in front of the house, surrounded by pools of water and fallen flowers. Its branches were thick with scarlet, pea-shaped flowers. "All right," I said. The tree was easy to climb. I climbed on a lower branch, smiling down at her. "I'll throw them down to you." I bent a branch, but the wood was young and green, and I had to twist it several times before it snapped. "I'm not sure if I should do this," I said, dropping the flowering branch to her. "Don't worry," she said. Suddenly I remembered my childhood days, and a desire to stay behind in my grandfather's house with all its memories. But I was the only one left. What could I do except climb coral and jackfruit trees?



A. Choose the correct option from the following:

- In the sentence, '*night had been hot, the rain frequent*' the synonym of the word '*frequent*' is _____.
a) recurrent b) forever c) never d) always
- In the sentence, '*times before it snapped*' the antonym of the word '*snapped*' is _____.
a) change b) dynamic c) repaired d) challenging
- The narrator slept on the veranda because...
a) he wanted to smell the wet soil. b) he was waiting for the tonga.
c) it was hot. d) he wanted to check if the ceiling was leaking.

B. Answer the following questions:

- Where was the narrator going in a few hours? Why?
- How did the narrator feel about leaving the place?
- Describe the tree and its surroundings.
- How did you feel after leaving your previous classroom? Write a few sentences.

C. Make sentences with the following words:

- scarlet 2. suddenly 3. twist